AEO ANALYZERS · PIGENAI LLC

When an AI answers the question, who gets named?

Buyers have stopped typing keywords and started asking assistants for a recommendation. AEO Analyzers measures what ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity and Gemini (plus Grok on Pro and Business) actually say when they do and, a month later, whether anything changed.

The category arrived before the measurement did

7

Open roles in one week of October 2026 whose titles name Answer Engine Optimization or AI Visibility, at SailPoint, Expedia Group, AMN Healthcare and others. (Public job listings, read October 10th.)

2 of 21

SaaS marketing agencies in a 2026 industry roundup that publish a specific claim about how they measure AI visibility. (Read October 10th.)

0.9 vs 17

When we re-ran the same test on seven companies, the net average moved 0.9 points while a single company moved as much as 17. A steady average can hide a large move.

Companies are hiring for this by name and agencies are selling it. What has not been settled is how anyone checks the work. A screenshot of one answer is a single draw, not a measurement.

What we measure, and how

1. **One named panel, one to three runs, one date.** ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity and Gemini on every plan, plus Grok on Pro and Business, asked the questions your buyers type. When a fourth engine joined a three-engine panel, the average category rate moved by 14.0 points, so every result names its panel and no change is computed across panels.
2. **Two scores, never blended.** Whether an engine finds you when asked about you *by name*, and whether it recommends you when asked the category question with your name nowhere in it. On our own site on October 13th: found when asked by name in 75% of answers, recommended in 0% of category answers. One averaged number hides exactly that gap.
3. **Every answer stored.** The verbatim text behind every figure, the competitors named beside you, and a link to each date's transcripts. Nothing we report is a number you have to take on faith.
4. **The denominator shown.** Up to 60 answers on four engines, 75 with Grok; how many were scored, how many the engine answered from memory rather than a live search, and why any were excluded.
5. **Measured again next month.** Same questions, same engines, same number of runs. Two dates on one panel is a series. One date is a snapshot, and a snapshot can be dismissed as a bad day.

Four findings, each with its source

Two come from published industry studies, credited below. Two come from our own sweep of our own site, published with dates and transcripts at aeoanalyzers.com/evidence.

6 of 7	In a test published by Otterly.ai (December 2025 to March 2026), six of seven AI platforms could not fetch or correctly interpret a page's schema markup when asked, and none used a fact placed only in the schema to answer a question about it. Schema still earns rich results in classic search and still helps with disambiguation.
97%	An Ahrefs study of 137,000 sites found roughly 38,000 `llms.txt` files, and 97% among them received no requests at all in May 2026; and an SE Ranking study of about 300,000 domains found no link between having one and being cited by AI.
75% · 0%	Our own site, October 13th, 2026, four engines: found when asked by name in 30 of 40 answers, recommended in 0 of 200 category answers. Known when named, missing from the shortlist.
88% → 75%	Our own found-by-name figure from October 8th to October 13th on the same four engines. We published the lower number, because a ledger that only goes up is not a ledger.

What a customer actually gets

A monthly measurement of the category questions your buyers ask, across four engines (five on Pro and Business), with the answer text kept. The competitors named instead of you, counted. A second date on the same panel so movement can be separated from noise. And a report written so the person receiving it can check every figure in it.

For an agency, that is a reporting line you can put in front of a client and defend. For a founder, it is the difference between believing you are visible and knowing what the engines say.

Why you can check us

The method is published, not described. Which engines, how many questions, how many runs, what counts as a mention, and what was excluded.

We measure our own site every month and publish the number whatever it says — including the months it goes down.

When we get a number wrong, we correct it in the open. One published figure went from 265 to 36 after a re-score, and the correction sits on the record beside the original.

No method guarantees that an engine will recommend you. We do not claim one, and we would be careful of anyone who does.

Our own figures are published with their dates at aeoanalyzers.com/evidence. Industry figures are credited to their studies.

aeoanalyzers.com/evidence

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